MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS SPECIAL MEETING

Approved 10/16/2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Un~~approved minutes
September 30, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 3 Samantha Pitchford

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps and members of the public

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the agenda with additions, **motion carried**
*Additions
Health and Human Services
Motion: To allow County Administrator to approve any and all budget adjustments through the end of the day on September 30, 2024.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Members of the public thanked all members of the Board that have always supported the Airport and asked that they continue to support the airport.

Other members of the public spoke regarding their knowledge of elections and the extra hours that the County Clerk and her staff work in which they are not compensated. They are also concerned about losing the integrity of the election if the programming of the election is sent out of county to a vendor instead of being done by the County Clerk. There was also concern regarding paying more than double to a large out of county company for a service that is already being done in house by a local elected official.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Public Hearing for 2025 Budget
   Public hearing opened at 9:10 a.m.
   Public hearing closed at 9:24 a.m.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

1. Senior Services
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the grant from Region VII Area Agency on Aging in the amount of $274,674.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Housler, Hoefling, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Facon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES - continued

2. County Administrator
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to allow County Administrator to approve any and all budget adjustments through the end of the day on September 30, 2024, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Facon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve Budget Adjustments #24-189 and #24-187 in the amounts of $64,100.00 and $264,329.00 respectively, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Hoefling, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Facon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

2. Personnel
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to ratify the tentative agreements ratified by the following bargaining units, The International Union UAW Local 1974, Unit 1; The International Union UAW Local 1974 Unit 2; The Police Officers Association of Michigan Corrections Bargaining Unit; The Police officers Association of Michigan Non-Supervisory Unit; The Command Officers Association Command Unit; and The Police Officers Association 911, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Hoefling, Housler, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Facon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

3. Budget Fiscal Year 2025
   It was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to adopt Resolution #24-17, approving and adopting the County General Appropriation Act for Fiscal Year 2025, Chairman Haskell asked for discussion, Commissioner Fancon stated none of the constituents in his district support funding the County Airport because only one township and city benefit. Commissioner Fancon went on to confirm that if the commissioners are not good stewards of the taxpayers money then they cannot expect the department heads and elected officials to be good stewards of tax payer money. Guided by Commissioner Gilmore, Commissioner Fancon moved, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to amend the motion to suspend financing for the airport. Commissioner Ambrozaitis recognized Commissioner Fancon's continued absence from the Airport Committee meetings that he was appointed to and his failure to attend, while continuing to accept pay. Commissioner Hoefling questioned why there was movement to amend an already balanced budget. Roll call vote to amend the motion revealed:

   Yeas: (5) being Commissioners Housler, Majewski, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Fancon
   Nays: (3) Hoefling, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

3. Budget Fiscal Year 2025 - continued

   Roll call vote on the motion to adopt Resolution #24-17, approving and adopting the County General Appropriation Act for Fiscal Year 2025 and to suspend financing for the airport and revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Gilmore, Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (1) Ambrozaitis
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

4. Wage Compensation Resolution
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to adopt Resolution 24-18 establishing Fiscal Year 2025 compensation, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Hoefling, Housler, Fancon and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

5. Per Diem Increase
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to increase the per diem for the Board of Canvasser, the Jury Board and Election Commission from $25.00 a half day to $50.00 a half day and from $50.00 a full day to $100.00 a full day, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Fancon, Housler, Hoefling, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Kleinhardt and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Samantha Pitchford
   Motion carried

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

The Committee of the Whole meeting Scheduled for October 2, 2024 was cancelled.

Meeting Adjourned at 9:25 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk

Jeff Haskell, Chairman